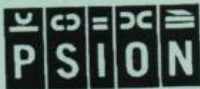


RANGER 

RANGERDISK

PC Compatible Floppy Disk Drive
for the

 **P S I O N**

S E R I E S

3

RANGER

RANGERDISK

PC Compatible Floppy Disk Drive
for the



SERIES

3

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CONTENTS

- 1 INTRODUCTION
- 2 INSTALLATION
- 3 OPERATION
- 4 TRANSFERRING DATA TO OTHER COMPUTERS
- 5 INTERFACE CONNECTIONS
- 6 SPECIFICATIONS
- 7 INDEX

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1 INTRODUCTION

GENERAL DESCRIPTION

The RangerDisk 3 is an external floppy disk drive for the Psion Pocket Computer Series 3/3A and MC400 mobile computer. Using RangerDisk, you can save word processor, database, agenda, spreadsheet and program files onto IBM-PC compatible floppy disks for archiving or transfer to other computers.

RangerDisk operation is basically similar for Series 3/3A and MC400 modes, with the exception of minor differences in screen layout, terminology and protocol selection. Series 3/3A can save files in batches: MC400 cannot.

Because RangerDisk is PC-compatible, it is easy to move data between any Industry Standard personal computer and Series 3/3A. In addition, the low cost of floppy disks means that you can keep a virtually unlimited number of backup copies of important files.

RangerDisk is a self contained external unit and connects to the Series 3/3A Serial Link or to the MC400 via a Psion serial cable. The unit is supplied with an AC adapter. A separate external rechargeable battery pack is available as an option - please enquire for details.

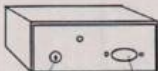
All the software necessary to operate RangerDisk is built into the drive unit, so that separate installation of software on the Series 3/3A or MC400, apart from the Series 3/3A Comms application, is not required. This means that the Series 3/3A's memory and card slots are not affected by RangerDisk, leaving the maximum resources available to the user.

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RangerDisk3
(Front view)



(Rear View)



DC Power in

Swaps connector to Series 3/MC400

Disk access light

Eject button

Write protect Tab
Open = Protected
Closed = OK to Write

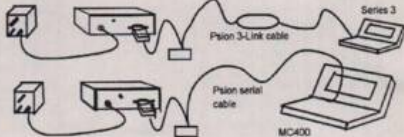
Density select hole
(1.44Mb Floppy Only)



A.C. Adaptor

Cable layout

Floppy disk (this way up)



2. INSTALLATION

RangerDisk for the Series 3/3A / MC400 is supplied complete with ~~connecting cable and~~ AC adaptor. Because all the necessary software is built into the RangerDisk, no software installation is required on the Series 3/3A or MC400. (Other than the 'Comms' application supplied with the Series 3/3A serial link).

With the Series 3/3A switched off, connect the 9-way (the smaller of the two connectors) connector on the Serial Link 3 RS232 cable to the socket at the rear of the RangerDisk. MC400 users: connect the MC400 RS232 serial cable directly to the socket at the rear of the RangerDisk. Plug the DC power cord attached to the adaptor into the socket at the rear of the RangerDisk. Plug the AC adaptor into a suitable switched AC outlet and finally, switch on the AC and power up the Series 3/3A. Your RangerDisk system is now ready for use.

Use only the AC adaptor supplied. Use of any other type of adaptor is not approved and may cause damage, risk of fire and/or invalidate the warranty.

Note that it is preferable to plug the AC adaptor into a switched AC outlet so that it can be switched off when not required. Alternatively, the adaptor can be removed from the socket. When connected to a live AC outlet, the adaptor constantly draws a small amount of power, similar to a video recorder or clock/radio, regardless of whether the RangerDisk is in use or not.

Next, it is necessary to install the 'Comms' application that is built into the Serial Link3 into the Series 3/3A, if it is not already present. MC400 users can skip this stage and go straight to "Setting the communications parameters".

Full instructions for installing 3 Link and the Comms application are given in the Psion manual supplied with the product. However, simplified instructions are given here. The reader is referred to the Psion manual in case of any difficulty.

To install the 'Comms' application:

- Press the System button to return to the System screen.
- Press the menu button
- Move to the 'Apps' menu using the ← → keys
- Select 'Install Application'
- Move to the 'Disk' line and select 'C' with the ← → keys
- Move to the 'Position' line and select 'First' (This places the icon for Comms first in the system screen.
- Move to the 'File: Name' line and type in COMMS. Press ENTER.



A new icon will appear in the system screen. Note that each of the files on this disk end in [C], as the 'C' disk is built into 3 Link.

Move to the item 'Comms' under the Comms icon and press Enter. The Series 3/3A screen will clear and show briefly the message 'online'. You are now ready to communicate with RangerDisk. However, before doing so, you will need to verify that the communication port parameters are correctly set.

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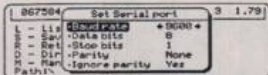
To set the communications parameters (Series 3/3A):

Once the Comms application is running and on line, press the 'Menu' key again.

Select 'Special' with the ← → keys. Select 'Port'.

In the 'Set serial port' menu, select the following with the ← → keys (You can skip if entries are already correct).

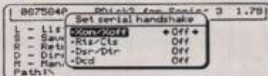
- Baud Rate 9600
- Data Bits 8
- Stop Bits 1
- Parity None
- Ignore Parity Yes



When all settings are correct, press 'ENTER'. The screen clears. Press 'Menu' again. Next, select 'Handshakes'.

In the 'Set serial handshakes' menu, select the following:

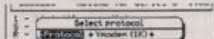
- Xon/Xoff Off
- Rts/Cts Off
- Dsr/Dtr Off
- Dcd Off



Press 'Enter'. Select the 'Transfer' menu. Select 'Protocol'. In the 'Select Protocol' menu, set the following:

- Protocol YMODEM(1K)

Press 'Enter'. You are now ready to use RangerDisk.



To set the communications parameters (MC400):
Select the terminal icon in the system application and press 'Enter'.

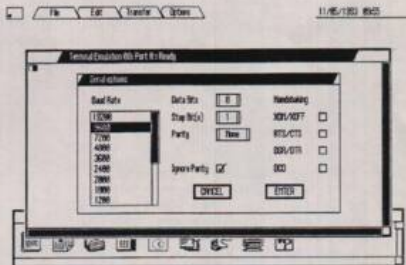
Select the 'Options' menu while in the terminal

Set the following parameters in the
'Serial Options' screen:

Baud Rate	9600
Data Bits	8
Stop Bit(s)	1
Parity	None
Ignore Parity	Checked
Xon/Xoff	Clear
Rts/Cts	Clear
Dsr/Dtr	Clear
Dcd	Clear

Set the following parameter in the
'Options' menu, 'Transfer' sub-menu:

Protocol	XModem CRC
----------	------------



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3 Operation

Logging On

On the Series 3/3A, press the 'System' icon on the touch pad above the keyboard. Find the 'Comms' icon by scrolling side ways with the ← → keys and launching it with 'ENTER'.

If you cannot find the icon for 'Comms', it is likely the the 'Comms' application is not installed or that the Series3 serial link is not attached to the Series 3/3A. MC400 Users: Select the 'Terminal' application from the system menu.

Type in the characters 'S3', followed by 'ENTER'. MC400 Users: Type 'MC' followed by 'ENTER'. The screen should say:

RDisk3 for Psion Series 3/3A
Please wait

If this message does not appear check the following:

1. Is the Series 3/3A / MC400 in terminal mode?
2. Is the Disk Drive connected to the Series 3/3A / MC400?
3. Is the AC adaptor connected to the Disk Drive?
4. Is AC power available to the Adaptor?
5. Have the Series 3/3A / MC400 communications parameters been altered ?

After a moment, the main menu will appear: (MC400 users: the time and date screen will appear first).

Note: This page applies to MC400 users only. Series 3/3A copies the time and date to each disk file automatically. MC400 cannot do this.)

RangerDisk uses the time and date to label your disk files with the time and date that they were last altered. You can skip the setting process altogether simply by pressing **↵** when this screen appears. In this case, the time and date will be set to the default values of 01/01/92 and 00:00:00. Any files that are written to subsequently will be labelled with this time and date. (Simply reading in a file does not alter the time and date information.)

Note that the clock begins 'ticking' as soon as you press **↵**, so that files created at 10 minute intervals will be labelled 00:10:00, 00:20:00, etc.

To set the time and date, type in the date information, followed by the time, exactly as shown on the screen. RangerDisk automatically includes the **'/'** and **':'** characters - as shown, together with a space after the date and before the time. It is not necessary to type in these characters. When you have finished typing the time, press **↵**.

Set time and date screen - MC400

Note that RangerDisk will not accept an invalid time or date, like, for instance, 99/99/99 99:99:99. If you make a mistake, just press **←** and type in a valid number.

When you press **↵**, the calendar clock will start and will remain valid as long as power is connected to RangerDisk.

The screenshot shows a terminal window titled "Terminal Emulation 88: Port A: Ready". Inside the window, the text "Please wait" is at the top. Below it is a rectangular box containing the text "Set Time and Date". Underneath the box, the date format "dd/mm/yy hh:mm:ss" is displayed. The current date and time are shown as "Current - 01/01/92 00:00:04". Below this, the word "NEW" is followed by a hyphen and a blank space. At the bottom of the window, there is a status bar with the text "RangerDisk Version 1.00" on the left and "Copyright 1991" on the right.

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Main Menu

When you have completed setting the time and date, RangerDisk will display the 'Main Menu' screen:

To select a menu item, simply press the menu letter indicated. Each menu item functions as as described in the following sections: (Series 3/3A and MC400 modes are similar, with the exception of file save and retrieve functions, which are described on separate pages).

List the files on disk

USPCX.EXE	24/06/92	RJ	FILE	38704
C.RTF	01/01/92	RJ	FILE	9216
WORD.RTF	01/01/92	RJ	FILE	4352
WORD2.RTF	16/04/93	RJ	FILE	2446
SCREEN.PIC	01/01/92	RJ	FILE	2420
USPCX.REC	24/04/93	RJ	FILE	807
MMENU.PCX	24/04/93	RJ	FILE	1867

Press Enter to continue, ESC to stop■

Main Menu screen

```
| 0670720   RDisk3 for Series 3  1.76|
|
| L - List files on disk
| S - Save a file to disk
| R - Retrieve a file from disk
| D - Directories
| M - Management
| Path:\■
```

Note: There are 2 further menu options not shown on the Main Menu Screen: 'C' to change to a sub-directory and 'P' to revert to the parent.

List the files on disk: Type 'L'. **Note:** It is not necessary to type upper case: either 'L' or 'l' will do. The Series 3/3A screen appears as follows: (this example assumes that there are some files on the disk to be loaded)! **Note** that you can press the 'Esc' key to stop the file listing and return to the main menu at any time.

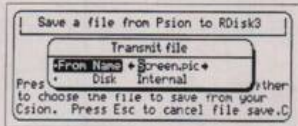
Save a File to Disk - Series 3/3A

Pressing 'S' brings up the save a file screen. This allows a chosen file to be saved from the Series 3/3A to floppy disk.

When the screen opposite appears, press 'Psion' and 'T' together to bring up the Series 3/3A transfer window. Press 'Tab' to bring up the list of file names in the Series 3/3A (See box 'The tab key').

Note that the list of files scrolls vertically if there are more file names than will fit on one screen. Select the desired file with the cursor keys, and press '↵' to select it. To select more than one file, press '+' to mark each file and '↵' to complete the process. Once selected, the file or files will be sent to RangerDisk automatically.

While transmitting the file, the Series 3/3A displays the message 'transmitting'. When the process is complete, the message 'Press the ENTER key' is displayed. Pressing 'ENTER' returns to the main menu. You can verify that the file is correctly present on disk using the 'list files' function.



Save file screen - Series 3/3A

Save a file from Psion to RDisk3

Ready to save

Press the 'Psion' and 'T' keys together to choose the file to save from your Psion. Press Esc to cancel file save.

Note: to save a file into a sub-directory on the disk, you must first select the sub-directory using the Change Directory menu described later in this section.

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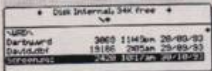
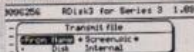
The Tab Key (Series 3/3A only)

On the Series 3/3A, the Tab key performs a special function. Whenever the name of a file name is requested, as in 'Transmit file', the Tab key allows access to the Series 3/3A's filing system. This access allows you to browse through the computer's disks, directories and files in order to find the one that you want.

To find a file, highlight the 'Name' field and press Tab. The screen shows you the files window. You can step through the disks by pressing the ← → keys. You may already be in

the directory that you want (WRD\ in this case). If not, move the cursor up to the top of the screen and press enter

when it is positioned on the 'v' symbol. Select the directory

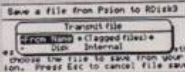
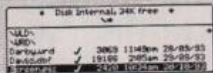


that you want and press Enter. Position the cursor on the file and press Enter again. The file is selected.

If you want to select more than one file, position the cursor on the first file and press '+'. A 'v' symbol appears. Repeat the process with each file in turn. Finally, press Enter. The filename is replaced by 'Tagged files' in the transmit window.

Important note:

if the 'v' does not appear when you press '+', the cause is almost certainly that you have not selected the correct transmit protocol. The protocol must be 'YModem (1K)'.



As the files are transmitted, progress is reported on the the Series 3/3A screen.

Save a File to Disk - MC400

Pressing 'S' brings up the save a file screen. This allows a chosen file to be saved from the MC400 to floppy disk.

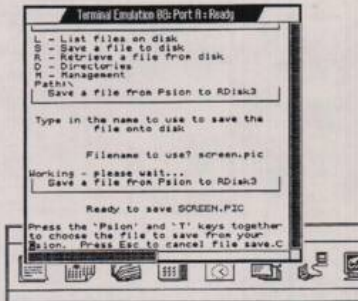
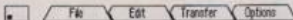
Type in the name that the file is to be called on the floppy disk, followed by '.J'. Note the filenames can contain up to only 8 characters, followed by a 3 character extension. An example is: TESTFILE.ABC. Only alphabetic and numeric characters are permitted. After the '.J' key is pressed, the MC400 displays the 'Ready to save' screen.

The meaning of the on screen instructions is as follows:

'Psion' and 'T' pressed together brings up the MC400 transfer window. Press 'Tab' to bring up the list of file names in the MC400.

Note that the list of files scrolls vertically if there are more file names than will fit on one screen. Select the desired file with the cursor keys, and press '.J' to select it.

Save file screen - MC400



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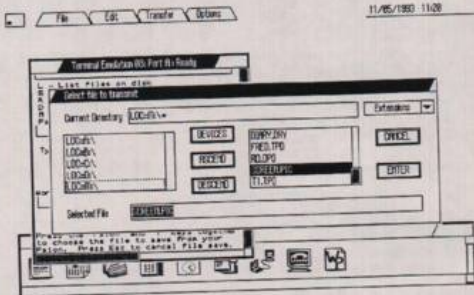
Once selected, the file will be sent to RangerDisk automatically.

While transmitting the file, the MC400 displays the message 'transmitting'. When the process is complete, the message 'Press the ENTER key' is displayed.

Pressing 'ENTER' returns to the main menu. You can verify that the file is correctly present on disk using the list files function.

Note: to save a file into a sub-directory on the disk, you must first select the sub-directory using the Change Directory menu described later in this section.

Save file screen - MC400



Retrieve a file from disk - Series 3/3A

This function fetches a named file from the RangerDisk and places it into the Series 3/3A's filing system. The initial 'Retrieve a File' screen appears as shown here:

Type in the name that the file is called on the floppy disk, followed by '↵'. Note the filenames can contain up to only 8 characters, followed by a 3 character extension. An example is: TESTFILE.ABC. Only alphabetic and numeric characters are permitted.

(Note that you can also use wildcards - see next section). After the '↵' key is pressed, the Series 3/3A displays 'please wait', followed by the second retrieve file screen:

Retrieve a file - Series 3/3A

Retrieve a file from RDisk3 to Psion

Ready to retrieve USPCX.REC

Press the 'Psion' and 'R' keys together to choose the file to save to your Psion. Press Esc to cancel.■

Retrieve a file -Series 3/3A

Retrieve a file from RDisk3 to Psion

Type in the name of the file to retrieve from disk

Filename to retrieve? ■

The meaning of the on screen instructions is as follows: The Psion and 'R' keys bring up the Series 3/3A's receive file window. If desired, you can choose the directory into which to save the file by moving the cursor to 'To name' and pressing 'Tab'. Press '↵' to start the file transfer process.

While receiving the file, the Series 3/3A displays a count of the blocks (1024 characters) received. When the process is complete, the message 'Press ENTER to exit'

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is displayed. If file transfer is interrupted for any reason, for example by pressing the 'Esc' key, the 'Retrieve has been halted' message is shown.

Note: to retrieve a file from a sub-directory on the disk, you must first select the sub-directory using the Change Directory menu described later in this section.

After 'ENTER' is pressed, RangerDisk then displays the message 'Retrieve has finished transferring the file - press any key'.

Wildcards (Series 3/3A only)

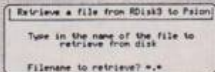
You can retrieve more than one file from RangerDisk with a single command by using the wildcard characters '*' and '?'. These characters substitute for ordinary characters in filenames to allow more than one file to be selected at one time.

The '*' character substitutes for any character or characters at its position or following it in the filename. For instance, '*' will select all files in a directory. 'A*' will retrieve all files beginning with 'A', for instance APPLE, AT,

A123 and so on.

The '?' character substitutes for any character or characters at its position. For instance, C?T will retrieve CAT, CRT, C1T and so on. You can use more than one ? character. A??LE will retrieve APPLE, ANNLE, A12LE and so on.

Note that the wildcard facility is only available in RangerDisk3 versions 1.84 and above. To determine which version you have, look at the version number in the top right-hand corner of RangerDisk's main menu screen. If your RangerDisk3 does not support wildcards, please call Ranger to find what upgrades may be available.



Retrieve a file from disk - MC400

This function fetches a named file from the RangerDisk and places it into the MC400's filing system. The initial 'Retrieve a File' screen appears as shown here:

Type in the name that the file is called on the floppy disk, followed by '↵'. Note the filenames can contain up to only 8 characters, followed by a 3 character extension. An example is: TESTFILE.ABC. Only alphabetic and numeric characters are permitted. After the '↵' key is pressed, the MC400 displays 'please wait', followed by the second retrieve file screen:

The meaning of the retrieve file instructions is as follows:

The Psion and 'R' keys bring up the MC400's receive file window. Press 'Tab' to bring up the list of file names in the MC400.

MC400 now asks for the name of the document to be saved in the MC400 memory. Note that this name can be different to that held on the floppy

Retrieve a file-MC400



File

Edit

Transfer

Options



RANGER

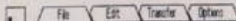
disk. While receiving the file, the MC400 displays a count

of the blocks (1024 characters) received. When the process is complete, the message 'Press ENTER to exit' is displayed. If file transfer is interrupted for any reason, for example by pressing the 'Esc' key, the 'Retrieve has been halted' message is shown.

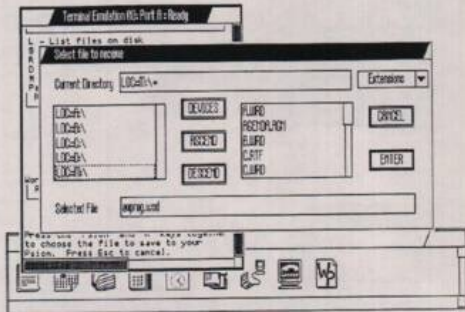
Note: to retrieve a file from a sub-directory on the disk, you must first select the sub-directory using the Change Directory menu described later in this section.

After 'ENTER' is pressed, RangerDisk then displays the message 'Retrieve has

Retrieve a file-MC400



11/05/1993 12:00



finished transferring the file - press any key'.

Directories

Pressing 'D' brings up the change directory menu.

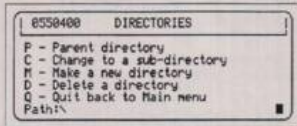
Use the 'C' key to change to a sub-directory. Note that the directory must exist. If it does not, you must create it first by entering option 'M'. To change from one sub-directory to another, first return to the parent directory using option 'P'.

You can delete a directory using option 'D'. However, the directory must be empty; otherwise, RangerDisk will warn "directory contains files" and refuses to delete. You can create a tree of directories within directories. (Up to seven layers of directory nesting are possible).

Any number, limited only by disk space, of files can be stored in any named directory. The directory structure is fully PC compatible. Note the path display at the bottom of the screen. The 'path' is the directory currently in use, including any nesting. To return to the parent directory, use option 'P'. Pressing 'Q' returns to the main menu.

Note: You can also change directories from the Main Menu Screen. Press 'C' to change to a sub-directory and 'P' to revert to the parent.

Directories



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Management

Pressing 'M' brings up the Management screen:

Format

The format option offers the choice of formatting DD (720K) or HD (1.44M) diskettes. Choose the option that is correct for the disk that you are using. RangerDisk will not format to the wrong density and will return an error if you attempt to do so.

Format displays a choice of screens depending on the disk density specified.

0074752 Format

D - Double density disk (720K)
H - High density disk (1.44M)
Q - Quit back to Management menu

Path:\

Management

MANAGEMENT

F - Format a disk
T - Set the Time and date
R - Rename a file
D - Delete a file
Q - Quit back to Main menu

If RangerDisk is unable to format the disk, a warning screen is displayed.

Format takes approx 90 seconds for a 720K diskette and 120 seconds for a 1.44M diskette.

Note that format erases all data on a floppy disk and that data erased by format cannot be recovered!

Format

Formatting double density disk (720K)

WARNING - this will destroy all data
on your disk
Is this what you want to do (Y/N)?

Format

Formatting high density disk (1.44M)

WARNING - this will destroy all data
on your disk
Is this what you want to do (Y/N)?

Format

Format has failed - please check that

There is a disk in the drive
The write-protect tab is closed
The disk is the correct density
- press the Enter key

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Time and date

Series 3/3A users: When a file is copied from Series 3/3A to RangerDisk, file creation time and date information is copied automatically to the disk. RangerDisk's internal calendar clock is not used for this purpose and does not have to be set. The time and date option is only used if it is desired to label new sub-directories on the floppy disk.

MC400 Users: MC400 cannot transfer date and time automatically, and so it is necessary to set the time and date information into RangerDisk's calendar clock manually, using the time and date option, 'T.'. The time and date setting remains current as long as power is maintained to RangerDisk. However, if power is removed, the time and date will have to be reset.

0727040	Rename file
Path:\	
Rename which file? █	

0432120	Rename file
Path:\aveling	
Existing filename: CGARDEN.USD	
New name? au007.usd █	

Note that RangerDisk automatically adds the ':' symbols between the date digits and '.' between the time digits.

Rename a file

Rename allows any disk file to be renamed. Type in the name of the file to be renamed, and then the new name. If RangerDisk cannot find the file to be renamed, it will return with a warning message. Note that the new name must not already exist.

Delete a file

Delete allows any disk file to be deleted. Delete asks "Do you want to delete this file?" as a check. Type 'Y' to confirm, or 'N' to abort.

0721820	Delete file
Path:\	
Delete which file? cvf.wrd	

0721920	Delete file
Path:\	
Filename entered: cvf.wrd	
Do you want to delete it (Y/N)?	

4. Transferring data to other computers

RangerDisk guarantees that data copied from Psion Series 3, 3A and MC400 computers can always be read by any IBM compatible computer. This is because the floppy disk that RangerDisk produces is formatted and structured exactly in accordance with the rules adopted for all industry standard PC's.

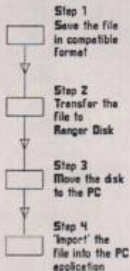
Unfortunately, the same cannot be said of the content of the files written by the Psion machines. These files are often written in ways that are unique to Psion and are not recognised by application programs such as word processors running on PC's. The result is that although the PC can perfectly well read the file from the RangerDisk disk, the PC application being used may not be able to make sense of it.

Fortunately, there are solutions to these problems. The approach is different for each Psion file type and we deal with each in the following sections.

4.1 Word processors

Most PC word processors cannot read Psion's "normal" (.WRD) document format successfully. However, Psion provide two

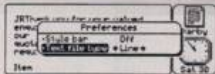
Transferring files to PC applications - the four steps



alternatives: "Text" and "Rtf", in which a file can be stored. Documents can be stored in these formats using options in the "Save as" menu, as shown below, and then copied to RangerDisk. To save a file in either Text or Rtf format, choose 'File save as' from the menu in Word and select 'Text' or 'Rtf' using the ← → keys in 'File type'.

TEXT. Also known as ASCII, text is the lowest common denominator of all document formats. ASCII stands for "American Standard Code for Information Interchange" and is recognised by virtually every PC application.

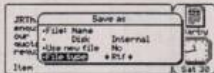
Because it is the lowest common denominator, ASCII strips away all text formatting - bold, underline, font changes and so on. All that is preserved is the raw text. (Some word processors refer to ASCII as 'raw text'). Despite this, ASCII is extremely useful in many applications where the objective is simply to transfer text to the host PC for formatting anyway. It also has the significant advantage that it always works!



We describe later how to import ASCII text into various PC word processors.

Retrieving Text files. Most PC word processors can save a file as text, or ASCII. When importing a text file to Psion Word, go into the 'Special' Menu and select 'Set Preferences'. Under 'Text file type', select 'Line'. (This setting suits most word processors. Without it, the resulting document may contain line breaks throughout and be difficult to re-format.

RTF. The second of Psion's compatibility options is RTF, or 'Rich Text Format'. Many PC word processors can read RTF. When using RTF, highlights such as bold, underline and italic are transferred along with font and style information. At a basic level, RTF is actually very easy to

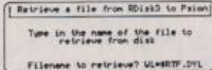


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use. For further information, refer to the 'ENGLISH.DOC' file in the WDR directory on Psion's 'LINK' disk supplied with the 3 Link (You can read this disk directly in RangerDisk).

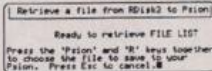
MC400 Users. RTF format is built into the MC400 word software (NOT the text processor) and can be accessed simply as a file type option when saving or opening files.

Series 3/3a Users. As supplied by Psion, the Series 3/3a does not contain facilities for RTF. Two special files have to be loaded from the floppy disk supplied with Psion's 3-Link in order to allow provide RTF facilities.



(Don't confuse the WWRD and WWRD directories - while WWRD is the directory where Word Processor documents are stored, WWRD is where the Word

Processor keeps special files of various kinds - templates, and add-on software or printer drivers. WL\$RTF.DYL has the software to open RTF files, and WS\$RTF.DYL the software to save them - you don't have to copy both.)



Before you can save and open RTF files on your Series 3/3A you must copy the WL\$RTF.DYL and WS\$RTF.DYL files supplied on the 3 Link disk to the series 3/3a. The files must be copied to a \WDR\ directory on the Series 3/3a. You can use the Internal disk or, if you want to avoid using up internal memory, an SSD in drive A or B.



Place the 3 Link disk into RangerDisk and press 'L' to verify that you can read it. Press 'ESC' to terminate the listing. Select the \WDR directory. Press 'R' to start the retrieve process. At 'Filename to retrieve?', type WL*\$RTF.DYL. (The wildcard retrieves both files). Press Enter.

Press 'Psion R' when instructed and select the \WDR\ directory by pressing 'TAB' in the 'To name' field. (If the directory \WDR\ does not exist, you will have to create it. Make sure that it is in the root, or '\ directory). RangerDisk will transfer the two files.

When you next use the 'Open file' or 'Save as' options in the Word Processor, you will now be able to set the 'File type' line to RTF, and select an RTF file.

Note: when the file is next saved - and this will happen if you switch to a different file - it will be saved in Word Processor format, complete with style and emphasis information. The .WRD file extension will be used. If at some point you want to send the file back to the PC or Macintosh, use the 'Save as' option and make a new RTF version of the file.

In most cases, modern word processors will prompt automatically for file conversion when an RTF file is selected for 'Open'. Simply choose the 'RTF' option from the list of conversions offered. If RTF does not appear amongst the available options, the word processor in question probably does not support it. This is true of many older DOS word processors.

Remember that word processors will not save automatically in RTF format, but will revert to their native format if simply told to 'Save'. To overcome this, use the 'Save as' menu and select RTF as the format option.

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4.2 Database Files

It is beyond the scope of this manual to describe the principles of database operation and management. It is assumed that the user is familiar with the database package that he has selected to use on his PC and wishes to import data from the Series 3/3a into an existing structure.



Databases: A brief glossary

Field: Each line of data

Delimiter: A character separating each field.

Record: each screen of data in the database. A record is made up of fields.

Database: A collection of records.

The series 3/3a database

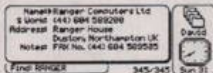
application can save data in a variety of formats under the heading of 'text'. To save a database file as text, enter the file menu in the database and select 'Save as'. In Save as, select 'Save as' as Text and 'Delimiter' as 'Tab'. (The delimiter separates data elements, or fields, in a PC database. Tab is the most common delimiter used). Name the new file and save it.

Transfer the file to RangerDisk. In the PC database program, open a database format that has the same or a greater number of fields than the Series 3/3a database.

For example, to copy the Psion database to a PC application, you will need at least 6 fields of at least 20 characters each for the data. (You may need more: the Psion database allows long lines).

It will be helpful if the names of the fields on the PC are the same as those in the Psion.

Typical Psion database record



Create a compatible field structure...

Field Definition

Database: PSION

Name	Type	Length
NAME	Text	20
TELEPHONE	Text	20
TELEHOME	Text	20
ADDRESS	Text	20
ADDR2	Text	20
NOTES	Text	20

Name: Type: Length:

NOTES Text 20

order.

Finally, read the data in. Each Psion record will now correspond to a record in the new database.

Find the command to 'Import Text'. Most database packages give an import facility, with a variety of native database formats like dBaseIII, dBaseIV, etc. Amongst these will be 'Text' or 'ASCII'. Select this option and, if available, select 'Tab' as the delimiter. The example shown here is from Microsoft Approach, but most Windows packages are similar.

Next, map the Psion fields into the new database. Some packages allow this mapping, as in the case of Approach shown here. Other packages simply read the fields in sequential order, and import the data as text.

Import Data

File Name: Directory:

Text File Options

Separate fields with:

☐ Commas

☐ Semicolons

☐ Spaces

☒ Tab

☐ Other:

Character Set

☒ Windows (ANSI)

☐ DOS or OS/2 (PC-8)

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4.3 Spreadsheets

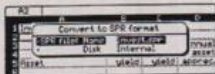
Spreadsheets are the simplest type of file to transfer because the Series 3/3A and the MC400 support an industry standard file format, WK1. The WK1 format is accepted by virtually every Spreadsheet on the PC, including Lotus 123, Microsoft Excel and Supercalc.

To save a file in WK1 spreadsheet format, select 'File type' in the File save as' menu and the File type to 'WK1' using the ← → keys.

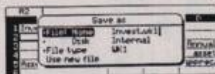
To retrieve a spreadsheet, first save the data in WK1 format on your PC. Most PC word processors can save WK1 files, although documentation on how to do so may be sketchy. In 123 for Windows, for example, the procedure is simply to alter the file extension from WK3 (The normal 123 for Windows format) to WK1 when saving the file. On the Series 3/3A, Open the file in the usual way. The Series 3/3A will respond with the 'Convert to SPR

format' screen. Press Enter. The rest is automatic.

Importing a WK1 file



Saving a WK1 file



Saving a file as WK1 from 123W



5**RANGERDISK3
RS232/V24 INTERFACE CONNECTIONS**

PIN No.	Signal	Function
1		No Connection
2	Rxd	Received data to the RangerDisk
3	Txd	Transmitted data from the RangerDisk.
4	DTR	Data Terminal Ready. Status signal from the RangerDisk indicating that power has been applied and the unit is ready for use.
5	GND	Signal Ground
6		No Connection
7	RTS	Ready To Send. Handshaking line from the RangerDisk indicating to host that data may be sent.
8	CTS	Clear to Send. Handshaking line to the RangerDisk indicating whether user's equipment is ready to accept data.
9		No Connection

RANGER

6

Functional Specifications

Disk Format	MS-DOS 3.3 Compatible
Media capacity	1.44Mb formatted (720K format also supported)
Type	3.5" IBM PS/2 compatible hard jacket floppy disk
M.T.B.F.	Approx 10,000 Hours
M.T.T.R.	20 Minutes
Mechanism Life	5 Years
Dimensions	185mm (L) x 117mm (W) x 43mm (H)
Weight	Approx 1Kg
Power Supply	6-9v DC @ 100mA max
Files	IBM PC Compatible, 224 Max in root directory
Directories	Max 224 sub-directories in root and subsequent directories. Number of files in each directory limited only by Disk space. Max path length 64 bytes.

Environmental Specifications

	Operational	Non-Operational
Temperature	+5 to +45 deg C (No condensation)	20 to +50 deg C (No condensation)
Humidity	20% to 80% RH, non-condensing	1% to 95% RH, non-condensing
Altitude	Sea level to 15,000 ft. (4,500m)	Sea level to 40,000 ft. (12,000m)
Vibration	Peak acceleration 2g in range 20-100Hz	Peak acceleration 4.5G in range 20-100Hz
Shock		Survive single 60G 10mS shock in any axis

7. INDEX

123 for Windows	30	Microsoft Excell	30
AC adaptor	4	Parity	6-7
Battery pack	2	Protocol	6-7
Baud Rate	6-7	Record	28
Change directory	19	Rename a file	22
Comms application	5	Retrieve a File	15
Communications parameters (MC400)	7	Retrieve a file from disk	17
Ccommunications parameters (Series 3/3A)	6	Rich Text Format	25
Database	28	Save a File to Disk - MC400	13
Database Files	28	Save a File to Disk - Series 3/3A	11
delete a directory	19	Serial Link 3	4
Delete a file	23	Set serial port	6
Delimiter	28	Specifications	32
Directories	19	SPR format	30
Field:	28	Spreadsheets	30
Format	20	Sub-directory	19
INSTALLATION	4	Supercalc	30
INTERFACE CONNECTIONS	31	Tagged files	12
List the files on disk	10	Text formatting	25
Logging On	8	The Tab Key	12
Lotus 123	30	Time and date	22
Main Menu	10	Transferring data to other computers	24
Management screen	20	Wildcard characters	16
		WK1 format	30

